

The output then is:

```
ajit.txt  anaconda2  astro
```

Now, instead of the folder and its contents, only files (*ajit.txt* and *astro*) and folder names (e.g., *anaconda2*) starting with 'a' will be listed.

Similar to the '-d' flag, other flags are also very important to filter out the listing, such as '-a', which will show all files and folders, including the hidden ones that start with a dot (.).

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Dynamic DocumentRoot for sub-domains

This tip is especially for Web server administrators. If you have plenty of sub-domains on your Web server and each one is in another directory on the server, then you can assign them dynamically as shown below.

Open the *httpd.conf/httpd-vhost.conf* file in any text editor and add the following commands:

```
<VirtualHost *:80>
    ServerName www.kishor.com
    ServerAlias www.kishor.com
    ServerAlias kishor.com
    ServerAlias *.kishor.com
    RewriteEngine on
    RewriteCond %{HTTP_HOST} ^kishor.com
    RewriteRule ^(.*)$ /var/www/html/$1 [L]
    RewriteCond %{HTTP_HOST} ^www.*
    RewriteRule ^(.*)$ /var/www/html/$1 [L]
    RewriteCond %{HTTP_HOST} ^(.*)\.kishor\.com
    RewriteRule ^(.*)$ /%1/$1 [L]
    ErrorDocument 404 http://www.kishor.com
</VirtualHost>
```

As you can see, the *DocumentRoot* is */var/www/html/*. This is the directory in which all other sub-directories for the sub-domains are located.

We use the *RewriteEngine* to decide which directory we want. The first *RewriteCond* is to route the domain without any sub-domain into the *www* directory. The second *RewriteCond* demonstrates how the third *RewriteCond* works with any sub-domain.

```
www.kishor.com => /var/www/html/www/
test.kishor.com => /var/www/html/test/
gavali.kishor.com => /var/www/html/gavali/
```

Finally, set up your domain as the wildcard domain **.kishor.com* in your DNS and enjoy dynamic hosting.

—Kishor Gavali, kishorgavali@gmail.com



The 'column' command in Linux

The 'column' command in Linux displays data from the file name given as an argument in a columnar format. The number of columns gets adjusted as per the size of the terminal. The blank lines in the input file are ignored. The columns on the left are filled first, before the columns on the right, by default.

For example, if a file named 'numbers.txt' contains the numbers 1 to 20, with one number per line, the command given below can be used to display the numbers in columns.

```
$column numbers.txt
```

The numbers will be displayed in multiple columns.

1	4	7	10	13	16	19
2	5	8	11	14	17	20
3	6	9	12	15	18	

The number of columns will depend on the size of the terminal.

The display can be from left to right, that is, the row first and then the columns, if the *-x* option is used.

```
$column -x numbers.txt
```

The output for the above command will be

1	2	3	4	5	6	7
8	9	10	11	12	12	14
15	16	17	18	19	20	

In case the fields in the input file are separated by a delimiter, the *-s* option can be used to specify the delimiter. The default delimiter is whitespace. The *-t* option can be used to get the display in a tabular format. The columns are delimited by whitespace unless the *-o* option is used to specify the delimiter in the output table. You can try the table and the delimiter option on the */etc/passwd* file, where ':' is the delimiter, and see the result.

```
$column -s: -t /etc/passwd
```

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